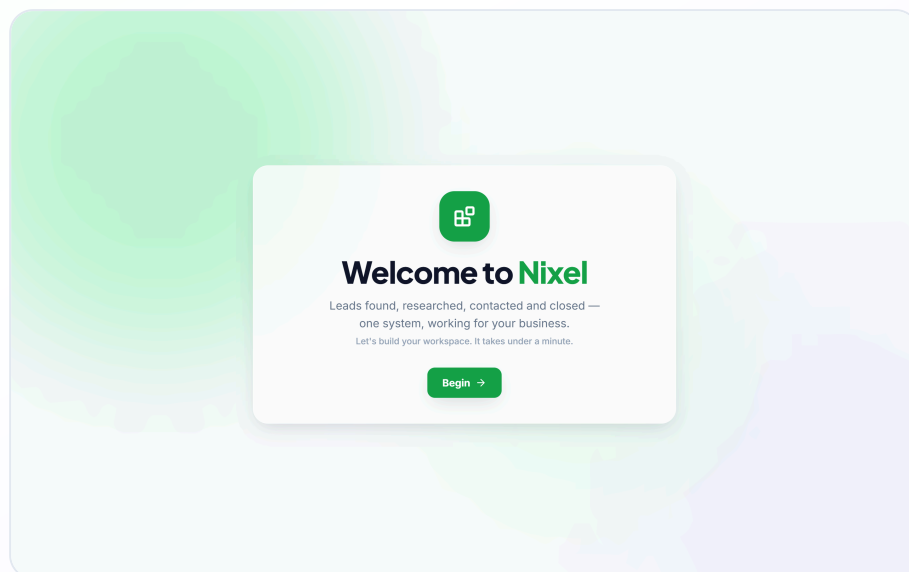




Starter Edition

Nixel **Business OS** Getting Started Guide

Everything you need to install Nixel, find your first leads and run your outreach — written for business owners, not developers.



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nixelai.com

What Nixel does for you

Nixel Business OS takes a lead from "we should find customers like this" all the way to a deal — in one place.

MODULE	WHAT IT DOES FOR YOU
 Lead Engine	Finds real businesses that match your ideal customer, researches their websites, finds contact emails, verifies them and scores how well each one fits — automatically, while you watch.
 Lead Workspace	Your master list. Review what the engine found, approve the good ones, reject the rest, export to CSV any time.
 Inbound Leads	Connects your website's contact form so enquiries land here automatically.
 Campaigns & Email Builder	Design professional emails (with personalisation like <code>{{first_name}}</code>), then send multi-step sequences with daily limits and sending windows.
 Automations	"When a new lead arrives → send the intro email → wait 3 days → if no reply, follow up." Set it once; it runs for you.
 Pipeline	A drag-and-drop board that tracks every deal from first contact to won.

How the pieces connect

Leads come in from the **Lead Engine** or your **website** → you approve them in the **Workspace** → **Campaigns** and **Automations** warm them up → replies become deals on your **Pipeline**.

Works the moment you install it. Lead search runs on a free built-in engine (OpenStreetMap) with no signup. When you're ready, connect Google Places, Claude AI and your email service in Settings — each one switches on instantly, no restart needed. Chapter 8 shows you how.

What you'll need

- ✓ A Windows or Mac computer (10 minutes for install)
- ✓ Two free programs: Python and Node.js (step-by-step below)
- ✓ Later, optionally: a Google Places key, a Claude key and email (SMTP) details to unlock full power

Installing on your computer

One-time setup, about 10 minutes. You'll copy and paste a few commands — no coding involved.

Step 1 — Install the two free programs

- 1 **Python** — download from python.org/downloads and run the installer. **Important:** tick "Add python.exe to PATH" on the first screen before clicking Install.
- 2 **Node.js** — download the "LTS" version from nodejs.org and run the installer. Just click Next through it.

Step 2 — Start the backend (the brain)

Open the **nixel** folder you received, then open a terminal there (on Windows: right-click inside the folder → "Open in Terminal"). Paste these lines one at a time:

```
# Windows (PowerShell)
cd backend
python -m venv .env
.venv\Scripts\pip install -r requirements.txt
.venv\Scripts\uvicorn app.main:app
```

```
# Mac / Linux (Terminal)
cd backend
python3 -m venv .env
.venv/bin/pip install -r requirements.txt
.venv/bin/uvicorn app.main:app
```

When you see `Uvicorn running on http://127.0.0.1:8000` — the brain is on. **Leave this window open.**

Step 3 — Start the app (the face)

Open a **second** terminal in the same nixel folder:

```
cd frontend
npm install
npm run dev
```

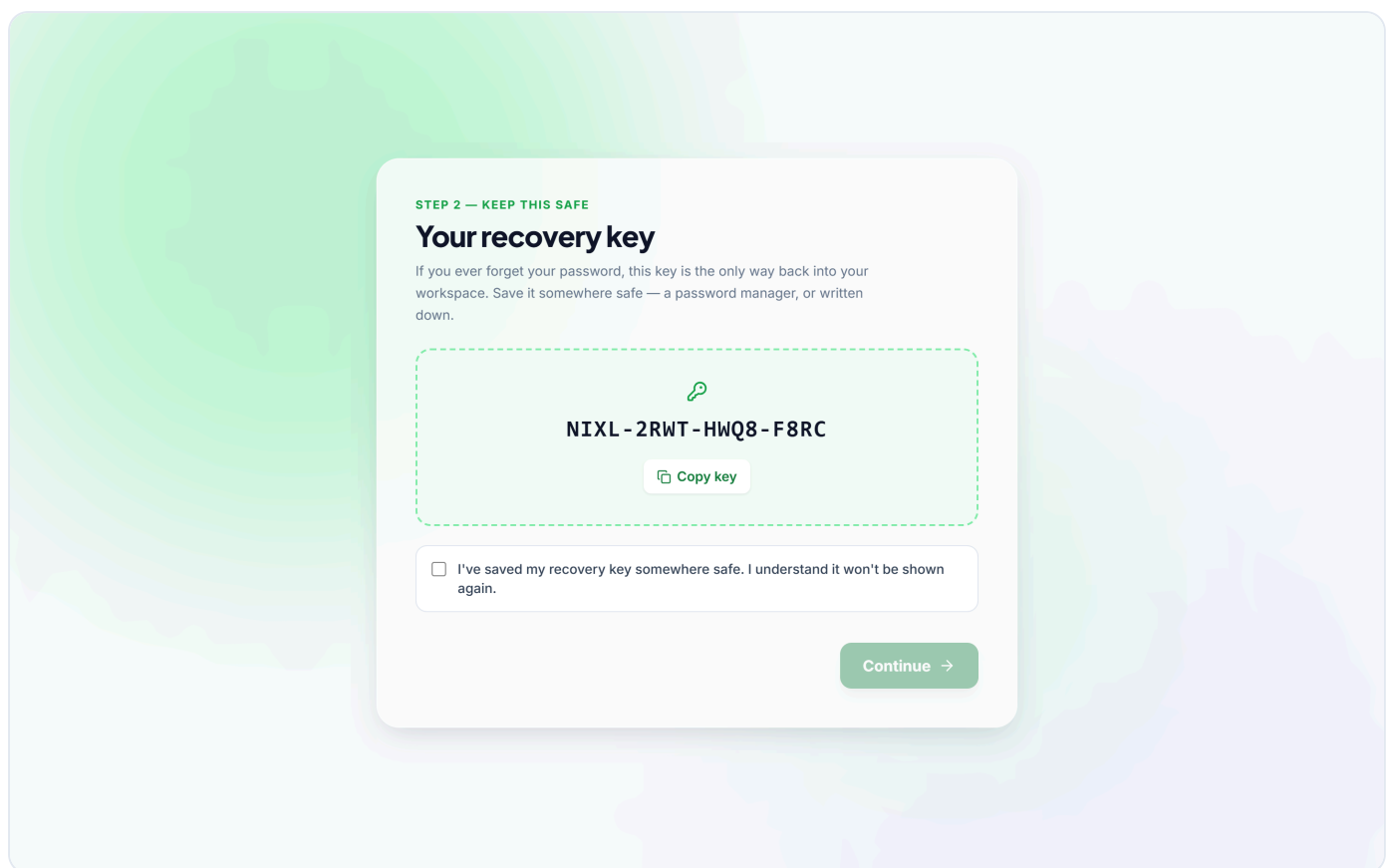
Then open your browser at **<http://localhost:5173>** (use the address the window prints). That's it — you'll land on the welcome screen from the cover of this guide.

Every day after this: just repeat Step 2's last line and Step 3's last line (the `uvicorn` and `npm run dev` commands) — the installs are one-time only.

Your first minute

The app walks you through setup: create your account, save your recovery key, answer two questions — done.

- 1 **Create your account.** Your email + a password (8 characters minimum — the strength bar helps you pick a good one). This stays on *your* computer; nothing is sent to Nixel.
- 2 **Save your recovery key.** The app shows a key like `NIXL-2RWT-HWQ8-F8RC` — **this is the only way back in if you ever forget your password**. Copy it into your password manager or write it down, then tick the box.
- 3 **Answer two questions** — your business name and what you do. Nixel uses these to personalise the app, your emails and your lead searches.

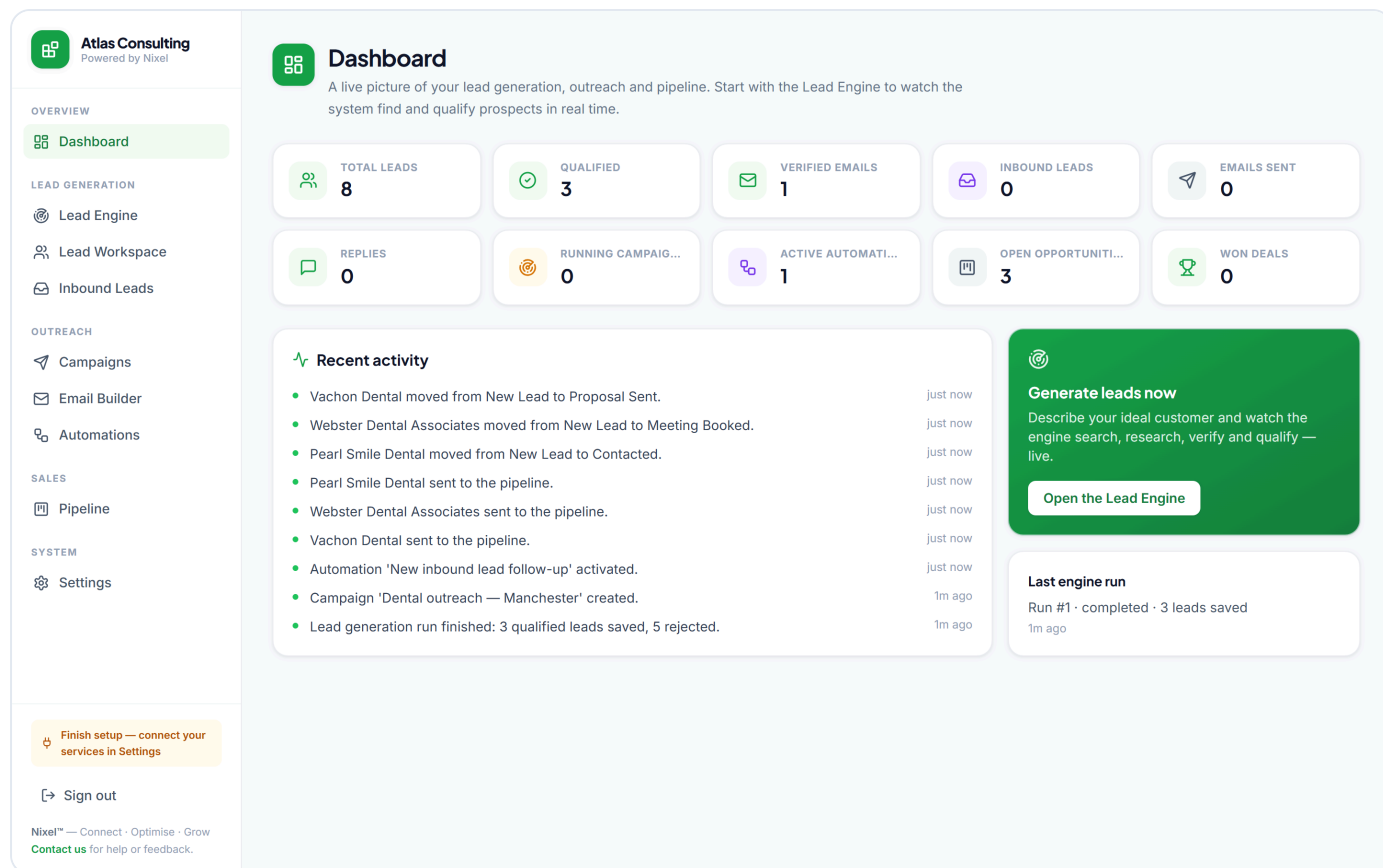


The recovery key screen — the one moment in setup you shouldn't rush.

Treat the recovery key like a spare house key. It's shown exactly once. Anyone who has it (plus your email) can reset your password — so store it safely, not on a sticky note on the monitor.

Your dashboard

Mission control. One glance tells you what's happening across leads, outreach and deals.



The dashboard after a first lead-generation run.

The tiles across the top count everything that matters: total leads, how many qualified, verified emails, emails sent, replies and open opportunities. **Recent activity** is your business's diary — every run, campaign and pipeline move is logged there.

The green **Generate leads now** card is the fastest way into your first lead search — which is exactly where we go next.

See the yellow "Finish setup" note in the sidebar? That's Nixel reminding you some services aren't connected yet. Everything still works — it disappears once you add your keys in Settings (Chapter 8).

Finding your first leads

Describe your ideal customer, press Start, and watch the engine work — live.

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Lead Generation Engine
Describe your ideal customer, press start, and watch every stage work live: searching, discovering websites, researching, finding contacts, verifying emails and qualifying leads.

You're on the built-in search (OpenStreetMap) — real businesses, no setup needed, but coverage and websites can be limited.
[Connect Google Places for deeper results →](#)

Search brief

INDUSTRY
e.g. Landscaping

TARGET CUSTOMER
e.g. family-run firms with an established local

KEYWORDS
garden design

LOCATION
Leeds

BUSINESS TYPE
agency, retail...

LEADS REQUIRED
10

EXTRA SEARCH CRITERIA
e.g. must have an active website; avoid national chains

Free text — the relevance assessment uses this too.

Start engine

PREVIOUS RUNS

#1 dentist **completed**

No run selected

Searching > Discovering > Researching > Finding contacts > Verifying emails > Assessing fit > Saving leads

Agent activity

Start a run to watch the engine work...

Finish setup — connect your services in Settings

[Sign out](#)

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A completed run: every stage logged, every decision explained.

- 1 Open **Lead Engine** and fill the search brief — industry (e.g. *dentist*), location (e.g. *Manchester*), who you're targeting, and how many leads you want.
- 2 Press **Start run**. The engine searches for real businesses, visits their websites, finds and verifies email addresses, and scores each one against your brief — you watch each step happen in the live feed.
- 3 When it finishes, qualified leads land in your **Lead Workspace**, each with a written explanation of *why* it qualified or was rejected.

About the built-in search: out of the box, Nixel searches OpenStreetMap — a free, community-built business directory. The results are real businesses, but some listings lack websites or contact details. Connecting **Google Places** (Chapter 8) upgrades your searches to Google's business data — noticeably deeper results, more websites, better emails.

Reviewing your leads

You stay in charge: nothing gets emailed until you've approved it.

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Lead Workspace
Every lead the system has found or received, with its research, verification result and a written reason for every qualification decision.

Export CSV + Add lead

Search company, contact, email, location All sources All qualification All review states All email states

	COMPANY	CONTACT	EMAIL	SCORE	QUALIFICATION	REVIEW	SOURCE
☐	Pearl Smile Dental Manchester, United Kingdom	—	info@pearlsmiledentist.c... Risky	78	Qualified	Approved	Engine
☐	Webster Dental Associates Manchester, United States	—	websterdentalassoc@gm... Valid	95	Qualified	Approved	Engine
☐	Vachon Dental Manchester, United States	—	— Not Found	15	Rejected	Approved	Engine
☐	Thomas Montemurno Manchester, United States	—	info@drtomorthodontics... Risky	73	Qualified	Approved	Engine
☐	Gentle Dental Manchester, United States	—	— Not Found	40	Rejected	New	Engine
☐	Brooklyn Court Dental Practice Manchester, United Kingdom	—	— Not Found	15	Rejected	New	Engine
☐	Manchester Dental Manchester, United States	—	— Not Found	15	Rejected	New	Engine
☐	The Dental Practice Manchester, United Kingdom	—	— Not Found	15	Rejected	New	Engine

Finish setup — connect your services in Settings

Sign out

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The Lead Workspace — filter, review, approve.

Click any lead to see everything the engine learned: the website research summary, the contact it found, the email verification result and the qualification note. Then decide:

- ✓ **Approve** — the lead is ready for campaigns and the pipeline
- ✓ **Reject** — hides it from your working list (nothing is emailed)
- ✓ **Add to campaign / Send to pipeline** — bulk actions for approved leads
- ✓ **Export CSV** — your data is always yours to take anywhere

You can also add leads by hand (the **Add lead** button) — useful for referrals and people you meet.

Emails, campaigns & automations

Build the email once — Nixel personalises and sends it for every lead.

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OVERVIEW

- Dashboard

LEAD GENERATION

- Lead Engine
- Lead Workspace
- Inbound Leads

OUTREACH

- Campaigns
- Email Builder
- Automations

SALES

- Pipeline

SYSTEM

- Settings

Finish setup — connect your services in Settings

Sign out

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All campaigns

Dental outreach — Manchester

Sends 09:00–17:00, up to 25/day. The background scheduler processes due emails automatically — "Process now" runs a pass immediately.

Draft

Start

Process now

Edit

4LEADS

0SENT

0OPENED

0REPLIED

Sequence

Introduction

+3d →

Follow-up

Leads (4)

Send log (0)

COMPANY	EMAIL	STATUS	STEP	NEXT SEND	
Thomas Montemurno	info@drtomorthodontics.com	Queued	0 / 2	Aug 5, 01:54 AM	
Vachon Dental	—	Queued	0 / 2	Aug 5, 01:54 AM	
Webster Dental Associates	websterdentalassoc@gmail.com	Queued	0 / 2	Aug 5, 01:54 AM	
Pearl Smile Dental	info@pearlsmiledentist.co.uk	Queued	0 / 2	Aug 5, 01:54 AM	

A two-step campaign: intro email, then an automatic follow-up 3 days later.

Email Builder

Compose emails from simple blocks (heading, text, button, divider, footer). Type `{{first_name}}` or `{{company_name}}` anywhere and each recipient gets their own version. The preview shows exactly how it will look, and you can send yourself a test.

Campaigns

A campaign is a sequence: *day 0 — introduction; day 3 — follow-up*. Set a daily limit and a sending window (e.g. weekdays 9–5) so your outreach looks human, add your approved leads, press Start. If someone replies, their sequence stops automatically.

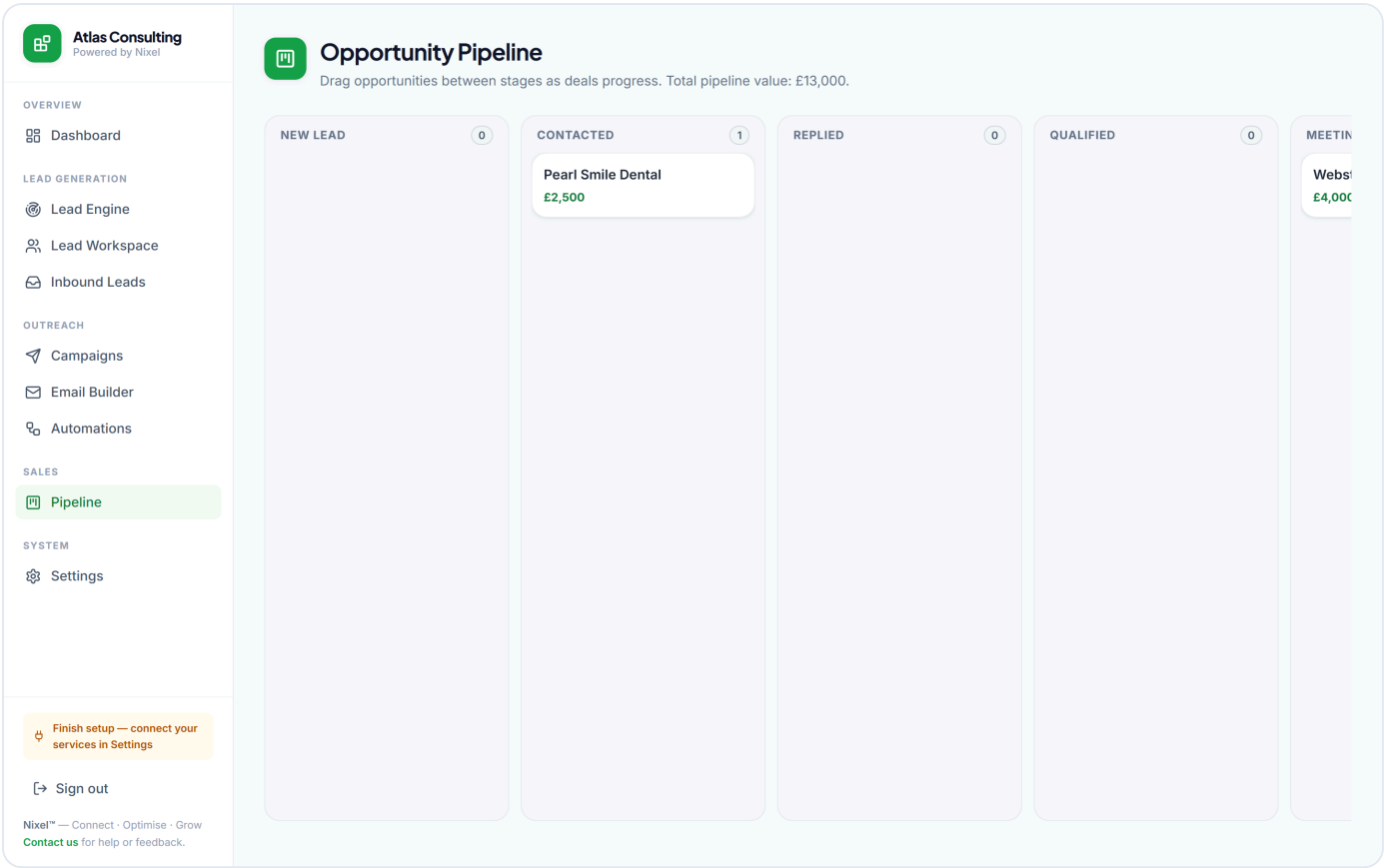
Automations

Rules that run without you: *"When an inbound lead arrives → send the intro → wait 3 days → stop if they replied → otherwise create a pipeline opportunity."* Every automation starts in **simulation mode** — it logs what it *would* do so you can check the logic before switching it live.

Sending requires your email service to be connected (Chapter 8). Until then, campaign sends will show as "failed" with a note telling you to connect SMTP — nothing is silently lost.

Your sales pipeline

Every conversation that turns into an opportunity gets a card. Drag it right as the deal progresses.



The board tracks stage and value — the header totals your open pipeline.

Stages run from **New Lead** through **Contacted**, **Replied**, **Meeting Booked**, **Proposal Sent** and **Negotiation to Won** (or Lost). Click a card to set its value, add notes, or review the full history of that lead — every email sent, every stage change.

Opportunities appear here when you click **Send to pipeline** in the Lead Workspace, or automatically via an automation step.

Connecting your services

Three optional connections unlock full power. Paste each key in **Settings** → **Connections** — it switches on instantly.

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OVERVIEW

Dashboard

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Pipeline

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Settings

Finish setup — connect your services in Settings

Sign out

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Settings

Your business profile and service connections live here. Credentials are stored only in your own local database and are never shown again once saved.

Business profile

BUSINESS NAME

Atlas Consulting

Shown as the app name and used as {{business_name}} in emails.

INDUSTRY

Marketing

TARGET AUDIENCE

Default brief for lead relevance assessment.

TARGET LOCATION

PRIMARY OFFER

done-for-you social media management

Used as {{primary_offer}} in emails.

INBOUND WEBHOOK KEY

Leave blank to use the .env value

Protects the inbound lead endpoint your website forms post to. Use a long random value.

Connection status

Each capability switches on automatically the moment its connection is saved.

Lead search

Built-in (OpenStreetMap) — connect Google Places...

Not connected

Connections

Paste your service keys here. Saved credentials are never displayed again — type a new value to replace one.

Lead search — Google Places

Finds real businesses that match your search brief. Create a key in Google Cloud Console with the Places API enabled.

GOOGLE PLACES API KEY

AI lead scoring — Claude

Upgrades lead scoring from the built-in rules to AI judgement. Get a key from console.anthropic.com.

CLAUDE (ANTHROPIC) API KEY

Email sending — SMTP

Works with any SMTP provider: AWS SES, Postmark, Mailgun, SendGrid, Google Workspace and others. Your provider's dashboard shows these values.

SMTP HOST

e.g. smtp.eu.mailgun.org

SMTP PORT

Configured — type to replace

Usually 587.

SMTP USERNAME

SMTP PASSWORD

Settings — profile on the left, connections and live status on the right. Saved keys are never displayed again.

CONNECTION	WHAT IT UNLOCKS	WHERE TO GET IT
Google Places	Much deeper lead searches with better websites and contact data.	console.cloud.google.com → create a key with "Places API" enabled. Google gives free monthly credit that covers typical use.
Claude (AI)	AI judgement on every lead — smarter scoring with a written reason. Without it, a sensible built-in scorer is used.	console.anthropic.com → API Keys.
Email (SMTP)	Real sending for campaigns, automations and tests.	Your email provider's dashboard (AWS SES, Postmark, Mailgun, SendGrid, Google Workspace...). Copy host, port, username, password and your "from" address.

Before sending real campaigns: use an email address at your own domain (not @gmail.com), and ask your provider about SPF/DKIM records for your domain — it's a 10-minute task for whoever manages your website, and it's the difference between the inbox and the spam folder.

The inbound webhook key (also in Settings) protects the address your website form posts to. Set any long random phrase; your web person uses the same key on the form.

Signing in & forgotten passwords

Your login protects the workspace. Three ways back in — you'll never be locked out of your own system.

Everyday sign-in.

"Use your recovery key" — reset without email.

1 — Password (every day)

Your password is never stored as text — only a scrambled fingerprint of it lives in your database file. Nobody, including Nixel, can read it back.

2 — Recovery key (forgot the password)

On the sign-in screen, click **"Use your recovery key"**, enter your email, the `NIXL-...` key you saved at setup and a new password. You're back in — and you'll be shown a **new** recovery key (the old one is used up; save the new one).

3 — Owner reset (lost both)

Whoever can sit at the computer (or server) that runs Nixel owns it. From the **backend** folder, run:

```
# Windows
.venv\Scripts\python -m app.reset_password
```

It prints a fresh password and recovery key. On a server, hand this line to your IT person — it's the whole job.

Putting it on a server

Running Nixel on your computer is perfect to start. Move it to a small cloud server when you want it always-on and reachable from anywhere.

What you need

- ✓ A small cloud server ("VPS") from any provider — roughly \$6–12/month is plenty
- ✓ A domain or subdomain (e.g. `nixel.yourbusiness.com`) pointed at it
- ✓ An hour of someone comfortable with servers — this is the one page to hand to IT

The plan (for whoever sets it up)

- 1 Copy the nixel folder** to the server and repeat the Chapter 1 install (Python venv + `pip install` ; then `npm install && npm run build` in `frontend/`).
- 2 Run the backend as a service** so it survives restarts — e.g. a systemd unit (Linux) or NSSM (Windows Server) that runs `uvicorn app.main:app --host 127.0.0.1 --port 8000` from the `backend/` folder.
- 3 Serve the frontend** — point nginx/Caddy at `frontend/dist` and proxy `/api` to port 8000. Enable HTTPS (Caddy does this automatically; nginx via Let's Encrypt).
- 4 Set two environment values** in `backend/.env` : `PUBLIC_BASE_URL` (your https address) and `CORS_ORIGINS` (same address). Restart the service.

Your data travels in one file

Everything — account, keys, leads, campaigns — lives in `backend/nixel_starter.db` . Copy that file from your computer to the server and your whole workspace moves with you. (Or start fresh on the server and run setup again.)

Never put it on the internet without a lock. HTTPS on, login required (built-in), and the server's firewall allowing only web traffic. If in doubt, keep it on your own computer — it's fully functional there.

Backups, hiccups & getting help

Backups — 10 seconds, once a week

Close the backend window, copy `backend/nixel_starter.db` somewhere safe (cloud drive, USB stick), reopen. That single file *is* your business data.

If something looks wrong

YOU SEE...	DO THIS
"Backend not reachable"	The brain isn't running. Open a terminal in <code>backend/</code> , run the uvicorn command from Chapter 1, refresh the page.
"Address already in use"	It's already running in another window — just refresh your browser instead.
Emails show "failed"	Email isn't connected yet, or the details are wrong — check Settings → Connections and the exact error note on the send.
Search returns few leads	You're on the built-in search. Try a broader location or connect Google Places (Chapter 8).
Want a factory reset	Stop the backend and delete <code>backend/nixel_starter.db</code> . This erases everything , including your account — export leads to CSV first.

A note on responsibility

Nixel Business OS — Starter Edition is a customisable starter system. Before storing real customer information or sending campaigns, you're responsible for appropriate security, privacy, compliance and deliverability reviews (the in-app notice has the full text). Anti-spam laws vary by country — get consent where required, honour opt-outs, and always include your real business details in emails.

Get help

Questions, feedback, stuck on a step? nixelai.com/contact — or the **Contact us** link in the app's sidebar, which goes to the same place.